DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 2

Graphic designer

Profession 2 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A graphic designer creates visual communication: posters, social posts, brochures, packaging and ads, using type, image and colour to carry a message.

What professionals do every day

Turns briefs into layouts, chooses type and imagery, prepares files for print and screen, manages revisions and checks brand rules.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Businesses need consistent, clear visuals in many formats. A graphic designer keeps the brand recognisable and the message easy to read.

- Visuals that are off-brand or hard to read.
- Print files that fail at the printer (colour mode, bleed).
- Campaigns that need many sizes quickly.

Skills you need

- Layout and hierarchy.
- Typography and colour.
- Photo and vector editing.
- File preparation: RGB for screen, CMYK and bleed for print.
- Brief reading and revision management.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Canva	Fast layouts and templates	Free	Paid plans	www.canva.com
Adobe InDesign	Multi-page print documents	Trial	Subscription	www.adobe.com/products/indesign.html
Adobe Photoshop	Image editing	Trial	Subscription	www.adobe.com/products/photoshop.html
GIMP	Open-source image editing	Free	Free	www.gimp.org

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish

Beginner	A social post in three sizes from one layout.
Intermediate	A brochure with a grid and a clear hierarchy.
Advanced	A campaign set with brand rules and print-ready files.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Event poster series.
- **Intermediate:** Product packaging design.
- **Advanced:** Multi-page annual report layout.

Client-ready portfolio project

A campaign of six assets (post, story, banner, poster, flyer, email header) for a fictional shop, built on one layout system with a brand sheet.

Worked example

Worked example. One layout grid, three sizes: the same headline position and the same colour rules, with the text re-flowed for each format.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

A six-asset campaign from one system

Business problem: A shop needs six assets for one campaign, consistent and print-ready.

Steps

1. Build a brand sheet: colours, two typefaces, logo clear space.
2. Design the poster in A3 with 3 mm bleed.
3. Resize the layout for the social and email formats.
4. Export screen files as PNG and print as PDF with crop marks.

Expected output: Six files and a one-page brand sheet.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

One grid and one set of rules produce all six assets. The print PDF carries 3 mm bleed and crop marks; the screen files are RGB. Checking the text against the contrast tool keeps them readable on phones.

Common mistakes

- Mixing RGB and CMYK without a plan.
- Forgetting bleed on print files.
- Too many fonts and colours.
- Text too small to read on a phone.

Freelancing opportunities

- Social and campaign design retainers.
- Print work: flyers, menus, packaging.
- Freelance briefs for 'graphic design', 'social media graphics', 'flyer'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Canva Design School
- Adobe Learn

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.